Maple Street District

AP Human Geography · Unit 3 · One stimulus (like Question 2) · 7 points · Teacher key · GeoArcade FRQ Tutor

The passage below describes how a single neighborhood in a mid-sized U.S. city changed over one hundred years as different groups moved in and out. Read it closely before you answer.

A Century on Maple Street: One Neighborhood, Three Communities

1920s. In the 1920s, Maple Street District was the German heart of Ridgeway, a mid-sized Midwestern city. Immigrants from Saxony and Hanover filled its brick row houses. They built St. Johannes Lutheran Church on the corner of Maple and Third, opened beer gardens along the avenue, and printed a weekly German-language newspaper, the *Ridgeway Zeitung*.

1970s. By the 1970s, most German families had moved to the suburbs. Mexican and Central American families arrived, drawn by factory jobs. The old church building reopened as Our Lady of Guadalupe Catholic Parish. Taquerías and a panadería replaced the beer gardens, a Spanish-language radio station went on the air, and residents began an annual Día de los Muertos festival on Maple Street.

2020s. In the 2020s, young professionals moved in. Coffee shops and a yoga studio opened, and rents rose sharply. The festival is now sponsored by the city and draws thousands of tourists, though several long-running restaurants have closed.

Maple Street District and the city of Ridgeway are fictional and were created for practice.

A. Identify the type of diffusion that brought German culture to Maple Street District in the 1920s. IDENTIFY

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ANY ONE OF THESE:

- Relocation diffusion
- Spread through migration: people moved and brought their culture with them

MODEL ANSWER

Relocation diffusion: German immigrants moved to Ridgeway and brought their language, religion, and food with them.

Common mistake: “Contagious diffusion, because it spread from person to person.” Contagious diffusion is when an idea spreads between neighbors who stay put. Here the Germans themselves moved to Ridgeway, so the culture traveled WITH people. That's relocation diffusion.

Why the model works: It names the exact type (relocation) and shows the evidence: immigrants moved and carried their culture with them.

B. Using the passage, describe ONE way the cultural landscape of Maple Street District changed between the 1920s and the 1970s. DESCRIBE

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Names a specific landscape feature from the passage (church, beer gardens, taquerías, newspaper, radio, signs, foods)
- Describes the change: what it was before and what it became

MODEL ANSWER

T1- The cultural landscape changed as the German community was replaced by a Mexican and Central American one, an example of sequent occupance.
E2- The passage says St. Johannes Lutheran Church reopened as Our Lady of Guadalupe Catholic Parish, and taquerías and a panadería replaced the beer gardens along the avenue.
A3- The buildings stayed on the same corners, but their names, foods, and religion changed to match the new residents, so each group left its own visible layer on Maple Street.

Common mistake: "The neighborhood got more Mexican people." That's a change in WHO lived there, not in the landscape. The question wants something you could see on the street, like the church becoming a Catholic parish or taquerías replacing beer gardens.

Why the model works: It names the overall change (sequent occupance), uses specific before-and-after details from the passage (the church, the beer gardens), and explains what the layers show.

C. Explain how the Día de los Muertos festival in the 2020s is an example of a cultural practice changing as it spreads to new groups of people. EXPLAIN

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Names how the festival changed: city-sponsored, tourists, commercial/commodified, mainstream, bigger, or adopted by outsiders
- Explains why spreading to new groups changed its meaning or purpose (cause → effect)

MODEL ANSWER

T1- The Día de los Muertos festival shows how a cultural practice can change as it spreads to new groups, and it shows signs of commodification.
E2- The passage says residents began the festival for their own neighborhood in the 1970s, but by the 2020s it is sponsored by the city and draws thousands of tourists.
A3- As the audience grows from neighborhood families to the city and its visitors, organizers may focus more on entertainment and bringing money into the city, so the festival can keep its name but lose some of its original focus on honoring family ancestors.

Common mistake: "The festival is more popular now." That says it changed, but not HOW it spread to new people or WHY that changed its purpose. Add who backs it now (the city), who comes (tourists), and what that can do to its meaning.

Why the model works: It names the process (commodification), quotes the shift from residents to city sponsorship and tourists, and explains how a new audience changes the festival's purpose.

D. Using the passage, describe ONE way religion is visible in the cultural landscape of Maple Street District. DESCRIBE

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Names a religious feature from the passage: the church/parish (Lutheran, Catholic, Guadalupe) or the Día de los Muertos festival
- Describes how it is visible or what it shows about the residents (building, corner, name, celebrated in the street, which faith)

MODEL ANSWER

T1- Religion is visible on Maple Street through its place of worship.
E2- The passage says German immigrants built St. Johannes Lutheran Church at the corner of Maple and Third, and the same building later reopened as Our Lady of Guadalupe Catholic Parish.
A3- A church building and its name tell anyone walking by which faith the residents practice, so the landscape shows the shift from German Protestants to Mexican and Central American Catholics.

Common mistake: "The people in the neighborhood are religious." That tells us about the people, not the landscape. The question wants something visible: name the church (or the festival) and describe what it shows.

Why the model works: It names the feature (a church), gives the exact detail from the passage (St. Johannes → Our Lady of Guadalupe), and describes what the building reveals about the residents.

E. Explain ONE centrifugal effect that the changes of the 2020s could have on long-time residents of Maple Street District. EXPLAIN

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Names a dividing effect on long-time residents: displacement, being pushed or priced out, losing gathering places, feeling like outsiders, tension or resentment with newcomers, loss of identity (gentrification)
- Explains the cause → effect using the 2020s changes (rising rents, new businesses, closures, newcomers, tourists)

MODEL ANSWER

T1- The changes of the 2020s could act as a centrifugal force by making long-time residents feel their community is being taken from them.
E2- The passage says rents rose sharply, coffee shops and a yoga studio opened, and several long-running restaurants closed as young professionals moved in.
A3- Because the new businesses serve newcomers and tourists rather than the families who built the neighborhood, older residents may feel like outsiders on their own street, which creates tension between the two groups and divides the community, a pattern geographers connect to gentrification.

Common mistake: “Rents went up, so it costs more to live there.” That's the economic fact, but it isn't a centrifugal effect yet. Finish the chain: higher rents close family restaurants and push residents out, so the community feels divided and loses its identity.

Why the model works: It names the centrifugal effect (feeling pushed out, tension), quotes the 2020s changes from the passage, and explains how those changes divide old-timers from newcomers.

F. Explain how the Spanish-language radio station is an example of a centripetal force for the community that arrived in the 1970s. EXPLAIN

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Names the unifying effect: unites or connects people, builds shared identity or belonging, preserves language and culture, strengthens community
- Explains how the station does it: Spanish language, news, music, information, events, listening together

MODEL ANSWER

T1- The Spanish-language radio station is a centripetal force because it unites the Mexican and Central American community around a shared language and identity.
E2- The station broadcasts news, music, and announcements in Spanish, so residents from different countries all hear about neighborhood events like the Día de los Muertos festival and local businesses in their own language.
A3- Because people share the same information and culture every day, the station strengthens their sense of belonging and keeps the community connected, even as the neighborhood changes around them.

Common mistake: “The radio station plays Spanish music.” That's what it does, not what it does FOR the community. Add the effect: hearing shared news and music in Spanish unites residents and strengthens their identity.

Why the model works: It names the unifying effect (shared language and identity), gives concrete examples of what the station broadcasts, and explains how that builds belonging and keeps the community connected.

G. Explain ONE way globalization or popular culture could threaten the local culture of Maple Street District, AND ONE way technology could help residents preserve it. EXPLAIN

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Explains a threat from globalization or popular culture and how it could weaken local culture: chains or global brands, tourists, commercialization, homogenization, local businesses replaced or lost
- Explains a way technology could help preserve local culture and how it keeps traditions alive or passed on: internet, social media, streaming, recording, online archive, apps, videos, podcasts

MODEL ANSWER

T1- Globalization and popular culture can threaten Maple Street's local culture, but technology can also help residents protect it.
E2- The passage says coffee shops and a yoga studio opened as young professionals moved in, while several long-running restaurants closed; if global chains replaced more local businesses, the district could start to look like any other trendy neighborhood, a step toward cultural homogenization.
A3- At the same time, residents could stream the Spanish-language radio station online and post festival videos and family recipes on social media, so young people and families who moved away can still take part, keeping the traditions alive even if the storefronts change.

Common mistake: "Globalization makes everything the same, so the neighborhood will lose its culture." Good start, but that's only half the question. You also need ONE way technology could help preserve the culture, like streaming the radio station or posting festival videos online.

Why the model works: It names the threat (chains and tourists replacing local businesses → homogenization), names a technology fix (streaming the station, posting videos and recipes), and explains the effect of each.

Scoring guide written for the GeoArcade FRQ Tutor. Award each part independently, 1 point each.